

PROPOSAL

Damp Experts Group marketing plan

Prepared for Alex by nu media group, October 2026

1. Where we are

The new Damp Experts Group website is live. Ben at Steady Bow is building the Google Ads campaigns for the different areas, and they will all send people to the main site. Nothing has run under the new brand yet, so there are no results to show. What we do have is a good starting point: four case studies with films, an online survey finder and booking system, and your own knowledge documents, which are a real advantage.

This plan sets out what nu media group does around Ben's campaigns to turn clicks into booked surveys and won work. Ben leads the Google Ads. We look after the website and the improvements that help it convert, search (SEO) and your Google Business Profile, your videos and case studies, organic social media, Facebook and Instagram advertising once Google Ads has shown us what works, referrals, the monthly reporting and liaison with Ben, and a list of further ideas to try.

Three decisions sit underneath all of it.

We put the marketing behind one website, the main Damp Experts Group site. Insitu and 1st Call Heritage already have their own sites.

The paid survey is a sale in its own right. It is not just a way in to the remedial work. Your own notes say roughly a third of jobs end with advice and no works. So we count every paid survey as a success, and treat the repair work as a separate stream of income.

Google Ads goes first. Facebook and Instagram advertising follows once we can see which areas and services bring in bookings.

2. How Damp Experts Group stands out

We looked at what competitors across Sussex, Kent, Surrey and London say about their surveys on their own websites. These are their claims, not proof of how they perform, and their offers change. The market is not one thing.

Some firms offer a free or discounted inspection, usually with conditions. Timberwise, for example, offers a free survey to domestic owner-occupiers but excludes home-buying surveys, condensation consultations and property health checks. Some sell a survey and nothing else: Academy Remedial Surveyors in Kent charges for surveys, says it does not carry out the work, and quotes £285 fully

inclusive for a home mover's survey on a one to three bedroom home. A few sit in between. Brighton Damp Proofers advertises surveys from £95 plus VAT, credited against works.

Competitor	What they advertise	What we can learn from them
Timberwise	Free survey for domestic owner-occupiers, with exclusions. 20 year damp guarantee	Their conditions are spelled out clearly. Compare like with like
Kenwood	Free surveys in selected locations, with some locations and survey types charged. Floor plan included	A floor plan makes the report feel real before you buy
Kenway	Free detailed surveys with drawings, and a limited-time discount on works	Showing the report as a thing you can see
Brighton Damp Proofers	Survey from £95 plus VAT, credited against works, 24 hour response	The same survey-plus-credit idea is already used locally, so what you show matters more than the offer itself
Max Damp Proofing	Free survey, 30 year warranty on eligible treatments	Cautious wording on what is covered
The Damp Specialist Company	Independent surveying and consultancy, with a sample report on its site	A sample report and clear area coverage
Academy Remedial Surveyors	Fee-based survey and written report, no contracting work, £285 for a one to three bedroom home mover's survey	A fixed price and a clear list of what is included
Tate Surveying Services	RICS-regulated chartered surveyors, no contractor relationship	A stronger organisational independence claim than most

Damp Experts Group sits in a particular spot. You sell a written survey, you offer a quote if the customer wants one, and you take £100 off eligible works if they go ahead. Paying for a survey and being offered a separate quote does not by itself remove the fact that the group also does repairs, so we say exactly what the customer gets and what is optional, and let the report, the people and the case studies make the case. This is where we can stand out.

There are five things we think you can own.

- 1. A survey with no strings.** Survey first, quote separately, and the report is yours either way, with no obligation to use you for the work.
- 2. Heritage and timber.** With 1st Call Heritage and Insitu behind the group, you can speak about oak framing, death watch beetle, lime plaster and cement render with more credibility than a general damp firm.
- 3. Naming the misdiagnoses.** A bridged damp proof course that looks like rising damp, condensation mistaken for damp, old salts blamed on the wall. Your Defect Library covers these in detail. Explaining them clearly, and without pointing at anyone, is a strong way to build trust.
- 4. The moment of moving house.** A fixed price, a quick report, and something a solicitor or lender will take seriously.
- 5. Landlords and letting agents,** once the rules settle.

3. What we say

The line stays: Diagnosed properly. Repaired properly. Sussex Damp Experts has become Damp Experts Group, and Insitu and 1st Call Heritage have joined it. For the first eight to twelve weeks, launch material carries a short "formerly Sussex Damp Experts" line, and mentions Insitu and 1st Call Heritage, so that past customers recognise you.

The message on any page, post or ad should let a worried person understand in one breath what they get: a survey by someone who looks for the cause, a written report, a clear price, and no obligation to have the work done by you.

The £100 credit. The £100 comes off the remedial works invoice when the customer goes ahead with the work. We will word it the same way everywhere it appears, and say plainly that the report belongs to the customer either way.

The guarantee. The website says up to 30 years depending on the work carried out, and that is the wording we use. It stays on the site and out of ads and social posts, because the cover depends on the job.

4. Who we are talking to

Homeowners with a problem now. They come from Google with a damp patch, black mould or a smell, and mostly want someone to tell them what is happening. They need speed, a price, a phone number they can tap, and confidence that they will not be oversold.

Home buyers. They have a survey that mentions damp or timber and a deadline. They need a clear price, a booked slot and a written report they can pass on. A building survey that flags damp or timber can lead a solicitor or lender to ask for a specialist report, which is exactly when a quick, written survey is useful. We will not promise that every lender or solicitor will accept a report, and we will say what the report covers so buyers can check with theirs. This group gets its own page and its own campaign.

Heritage and period property owners. They worry about the wrong materials going onto an old building. You are our strongest asset with this group. Your films and case studies on lime, breathability and cement render matter more than a hard sell.

Landlords and letting agents. The rules on damp and mould in rented homes are changing. Awaab's Law currently covers social landlords in England only, not private landlords, and the Renters' Rights Act changes began in May 2026. The useful offer today is a documented investigation and a clear report. We will not say the law already applies to private landlords.

Councils and housing providers. You already work with councils, so this group gets its own page. Social landlords in England now have legal timescales for dealing with damp and mould hazards under Awaab's Law, which makes a documented, evidence-led investigation and a clear report useful to them. They buy differently from homeowners, through a named contact, a quote or a supplier framework rather than an online booking, so we keep them out of the consumer booking route.

Surveyors, architects and solicitors. They only need to see that the team knows its subject. Technical case studies and your LinkedIn presence do that. We would also like to build a simple one-page pack for estate agents, surveyors and solicitors.

5. How we will know it is working

The website is new, so the first job is to make sure every result is counted properly. Ben is setting up the counting for phone taps, WhatsApp taps, bookings and payments, and we will check that each one works before anyone increases spending. A tap on a phone number is an action, not a call, and a tap on WhatsApp is not yet a conversation, so we report them separately from real enquiries.

The full picture is a chain, and we want to see every link.

1. Someone clicks an ad or finds you in search.
2. They land on a page and look at your films and case studies.
3. They ring, message, use the survey finder or book online.
4. They pay for a survey.
5. The survey happens and the report is sent.
6. A quote goes out and is accepted, or the survey ends with advice only.

Once a month you will get one short report showing how many people got to each stage, what each cost, and where people dropped out. It brings together Search Console, which shows how visible the site is and how many people click through, website analytics for visits and actions, Google Ads results from Ben, and your CRM for enquiries, bookings and won work. If we do not have a figure yet, the report will say so instead of showing a zero. Clicks and impressions are not the measure. Paid surveys and won work are.

Enquiries go into your CRM and your office team replies to them. We use the CRM results for the monthly report, and they let us pass the outcomes back to Google so the ads learn which clicks turn into customers.

Why the numbers matter. We are not going to set targets until we have four to six weeks of real data. To show how it works, though, here is the arithmetic, using round example numbers. It is an illustration, not a forecast.

Cost of each enquiry	If 25% book and pay	If 40% book and pay	If 60% book and pay
£40	£160 per paid survey	£100 per paid survey	£67 per paid survey
£60	£240	£150	£100
£80	£320	£200	£133

What decides how much we can spend is the share of enquiries who book and pay, and then how many surveys lead to works. Once results come in, we set the limit on what we can spend to win a customer from the real numbers: survey income without VAT, minus surveyor, travel and report costs, plus what the repair work contributes, and what your surveyors can handle.

6. Working with Ben

Ben runs the campaigns: the keywords, adverts, budgets and how the Google Ads results are tracked. We look after the website, the content and the social media, and we keep an eye on the whole journey, so that if something outside the ad account is holding results back, we tell Ben early.

For the first six weeks we will have a short weekly check-in with him, covering the tracking, the search terms people are using, the quality of the enquiries and how the landing pages are behaving. After that, a monthly report and a call. Ads need time to settle, so we avoid unnecessary changes in the first weeks. Anything that is clearly wrong, such as broken tracking, traffic from the wrong places, failed payments or money being wasted, is dealt with straight away.

If results look weak, we go through the same questions in the same order. Are the numbers right? Are enquiries reaching the office? Are they the right kind of enquiry? Is the ad aimed at the right action? Is the traffic from the right searches and places? Does the landing page do its job? Budget comes last. It stops us blaming the ads when the real problem is somewhere else.

Ben leads the Google Ads, and we pass our findings to him rather than run the account. A few ideas we will pass to Ben to consider. A small separate campaign for people searching for Damp Experts Group by name, so those easy clicks are reported on their own. Separate campaigns for homeowners, buyers, heritage and landlords, so London costs do not take budget away from Sussex. Counting the paid survey as the main result, with quotes and won jobs passed back from the CRM. And checking whether damp surveys qualify for Google's Local Services Ads in the UK, which we do not know yet and costs nothing to find out.

7. What people search for, and when

None of this is confirmed yet. Our tools could not give us reliable search volumes, so we have asked Ben for them. This is how we expect people to search, grouped by what they want. Broad searches such as rising damp or black mould are not all ready to book, so we judge them on results.

Group	Example searches	What it means for us
Homeowner with a problem now	damp survey [town], damp specialist near me, rising damp, black mould, woodworm, dry rot, damp basement	A mix of booking and research intent. We prioritise the searches that produce qualified enquiries.
Buyer	pre-purchase damp survey, damp survey before buying, independent damp survey, timber survey	Time critical, and looking for clear answers before they commit. Deserves its own campaign.
Heritage	listed building damp, lime plaster, period property damp, breathable damp treatment	Smaller numbers, high value and high trust. A small campaign, plus your films and guides.
Landlord and agent	landlord damp and mould survey, condensation report for tenants	A report-led offer rather than broad ads.
Information only	what causes damp, is damp a dealbreaker	Not for paid search. Feeds your videos, guides and the people we show ads to again.

Where first. Brighton and Hove, Worthing, Chichester and Horsham in Sussex, then Tunbridge Wells and Sevenoaks in Kent, then Guildford in Surrey, then London by borough. London clicks cost more, so we check before expanding there.

Searches to keep out. Ben decides the exclusions from the search terms report. The obvious candidates are job and training searches, DIY product searches such as kits and sprays, and areas you do not cover. Searches about insurance, cost or free surveys may still bring real customers, so we test them rather than block them automatically.

Through the year.

When	What people are worried about	What we lean on
Autumn and winter	Condensation, mould, water ingress, timber decay	Condensation and mould series, damp or not damp, seasonal advice
Spring	Renovation, buying and selling	Buyer pages, before you buy, survey walkthroughs
Summer	Basements, timber and period maintenance	Basement transformations, timber repairs, heritage projects
After storms or heavy rain, any time	Water ingress	Quick explainers, "is it damp or a leak?"

We will confirm these patterns from the real search data rather than assume them.

8. Search: growing the location pages

Location pages are how someone searching "damp proofing in Worthing" finds you without clicking an ad, and they keep working long after any ad budget is spent. This is the part of the plan that grows with every area you add.

Where we are

There are 50 location pages in Sussex, all titled "Damp Proofing in [town]": Brighton, Hove, Worthing, Crawley, Horsham, Chichester, Hastings, Bexhill, Haywards Heath, Burgess Hill, Littlehampton, Bognor Regis, Lewes, East Grinstead, Shoreham-by-Sea, Arundel, Midhurst, Petworth, Selsey, Lancing, Rustington, Angmering, Ferring, Storrington, Pulborough, Billingshurst, Henfield, Steyning, Hurstpierpoint, Hassocks, Southwick, Felpham, East Wittering, Eastbourne, Cuckfield, Lindfield, Uckfield, Crowborough, Seaford, Newhaven, Peacehaven, Rottingdean, Portslade, Hailsham, Polegate, Heathfield, Battle, Rye, Wadhurst and Forest Row.

What we do first

Before adding anything, we look in Search Console at how the 50 Sussex pages are doing: which are found, which bring visits, and which lead to enquiries and bookings. That tells us what a good location page looks like for this business, and we copy what works rather than guessing. The paid landing pages Ben uses stay hidden from search, so these pages are separate and can rank on their own.

How we expand into Kent, Surrey and London

Every page has to earn its place. Google treats near-identical town pages with only the name swapped as thin, and it can hurt the whole site. So each page is written for the place: the kind of houses and ground it has, the damp problems that are common there, a real job or photo from nearby where we have one, and the questions people in that area ask. A page that only says the same thing with a different town name does not get built.

Pages are built for what is true of each place. A coastal town with salt air and wind-driven rain needs a different page from a Weald village full of timber-framed houses, a Surrey town with large Victorian homes or a London borough with basements. The structure of the page changes as well as the words.

A page needs four things before it goes ahead.

1. We can serve the place properly, with travel time and surveyor capacity in mind.
2. We have something real to say about it: a job nearby, local building knowledge, or a clear local question.
3. There is evidence of demand, from search data or Ben's results.
4. It adds something that the other pages do not already cover.

Not every service in every town. Each place gets the services that fit it, for example basement waterproofing in Brighton, Hove and London boroughs, heritage and timber in the Kent Weald, and pre-purchase surveys wherever people move house. That keeps the pages genuinely useful.

Small batches, then check. We build around 10 pages at a time, give them time to be found, look at what they bring, and learn before the next batch. We do not publish hundreds of pages in one go.

County and service hubs tie it together. A Sussex, Kent, Surrey and London page sits above the town pages, and links to the service pages, the case studies and the survey finder, so visitors and Google can see how it all fits.

Local proof wherever possible. A case study from the area, photos from real jobs, and a link to the right Google Business Profile. This is also why the council and case study work matters for search.

The order

When	What	Notes
Weeks 1 to 4	Review how the 50 Sussex pages are performing and strengthen the weakest	Start with the biggest towns, such as Brighton, Hove, Worthing and Eastbourne
Months 2 to 3	First Kent batch and a Kent hub	First-wave candidates: Royal Tunbridge Wells, Sevenoaks, Cranbrook, Tenterden, Canterbury, Rochester, Whitstable, and the Weald. Lean on listed, timber-framed and heritage property.
Months 3 to 4	First Surrey batch and a Surrey hub	First-wave candidates: Guildford, Godalming, Farnham, Dorking, Reigate, Haslemere, Oxted, Cobham, Esher, Weybridge, Oxshott. Lean on basements, structural waterproofing and period surveys.
Months 4 to 6	London, by borough, and the rest of Sussex	First-wave candidates: Kensington and Chelsea, Richmond, Wandsworth, Fulham, Wimbledon, Dulwich, Hampstead, Islington, Clapham. Lean on basement waterproofing, Victorian and listed property, and pre-purchase surveys.
Every month	Measure and decide the next batch	Based on enquiries and bookings, not just visits

The towns above are candidates. The real order follows Ben's search data, where your surveyors can get to, and what the early pages bring in.

Alongside the location pages

The service pages, the guides built from Alex's twenty questions, the case studies and the buyer, heritage, landlord and council pages all feed the same search work. We keep titles, descriptions and internal links in good order, make sure the pages are quick on a phone, and track which pages produce enquiries and paid surveys. Clear answers, real photographs and named experts also help in AI-assisted search, although Google says appearing there is not guaranteed, so we do not promise it.

How we report it

Each month: which location pages are found and which bring visits, the enquiries and paid surveys that come from them, the pages we added, and what we will build next. Search Console shows how visible the pages are and how many people click through. Enquiries and bookings come from website analytics and your CRM, so we use the three together.

9. Adding to the website

The site already has what it needs to convert: area landing pages, a survey finder, online booking with payment and four case studies with films. These additions will help paid and organic visitors, in order of value.

1. **A page for buyers.** The fixed price, how fast the report comes, what a solicitor or lender gets, and a book button.
2. **A "what happens after the survey" page.** Report timing, the £100 credit, how quotes work, and what the survey is worth even if no work follows.
3. **A "meet your surveyor" section** on each survey page, with qualifications and a short video. It supports the paid survey straight away.
4. **A heritage and period property page,** built around you.
5. **A landlord and letting agent page,** written carefully around what applies today.
6. **A council and housing page,** described below.
7. **A fuller set of questions and answers:** how much, how long, how disruptive, whether solicitors and lenders accept the report, and who is responsible in a rented home.
8. **Guides,** using the questions in section 11 as titles.

The council and housing page

This page is written for housing officers, asset managers and procurement teams, not for homeowners. It sits on the main site, with its own contact route (a phone number and an email address for the team) instead of the survey booking page. It would cover:

- **Who you work with.** The councils and housing providers you are happy to name, and a quote or reference from them where they agree.
- **The work.** Damp and mould investigations and reports, condensation and ventilation, timber and structural damp, and remedial works.
- **How a job runs.** A named contact, how referrals arrive, how quickly you respond, how access to tenants' homes is arranged, and how tenants are treated while you are there.
- **The report.** What a council receives: photographs and readings, a clear cause, and a recommended action, in a format their teams can file and act on.
- **Credentials.** The accreditations already on the site, such as CHAS, Constructionline Gold,SSIP and the Property Care Association, plus your insurance and health and safety documents.
- **Proof.** A council case study, with the council's permission.
- **Awaab's Law.** A short, accurate explanation of how a documented investigation helps social landlords meet their timescales, without saying more than the law says.

10. Case studies

There are four on the site, each with a film: a bridged damp proof course in Horsham, hidden dry rot in a Tunbridge Wells basement flat, persistent damp in a Hove basement flat, and death watch beetle in a Grade II listed farmhouse at

Billingshurst. They are the right kind of proof and we will use them everywhere. This section is about getting more of them, one a month, and being specific about which jobs to pick.

Why case studies matter so much

A survey is something people buy on trust. The customer is paying for your judgement and cannot check it. A case study lets them watch that judgement at work on a real building, which is the nearest thing to trying before they buy.

They prove the line. "Diagnosed properly. Repaired properly." is a claim until someone sees a damp wall that looked like one thing and turned out to be another. Each case study is evidence for the line.

They answer the biggest worry. Many people looking into damp are afraid of being told they need an expensive treatment they do not need. A job where the answer was ventilation, a gutter or no work at all shows that you will tell them the truth, which is exactly what makes them book.

They work everywhere. One job becomes a page on the site, a proof block on a landing page, a few short videos, a LinkedIn post for landlords and agents, a Google Business Profile post and later a Facebook and Instagram ad. Pages with real proof on them are also more convincing to someone arriving from a Google ad who has never heard of you.

Competitors cannot copy them. Anyone can say "we diagnose first". Only you have the jobs, the readings, the photos and Alex's explanation.

Different readers need different proof. A buyer wants to see a survey change a decision. A landlord wants a documented investigation. A heritage owner wants careful, compatible repair. A homeowner with mould wants to see the cause fixed. One generic case study cannot do all four jobs, so we choose each one to prove something specific.

What we need

Each month, we need to know about one suitable job early, ideally before it starts, so we can capture it properly. For that job we need:

What	Why it matters
The customer's original worry and any wrong diagnosis they had before	It is the hook, and it shows the problem people recognise
What the investigation found, with readings and photos	It is the evidence that makes the diagnosis believable
The cause, in plain English	It is the moment people learn something
The repair, or the decision not to repair, and why it suits the building	It shows judgement, not just work
The result, and the customer's own words if they are happy to give them	It closes the story
Photos before, during and after, taken the same way	It gives us the visuals for every channel
A short film where the job suits it	It is the strongest format for the site and for ads
Written permission, saying where it will be used and that it can be withdrawn	It protects the customer and you

We describe the property by general area only, and any money saved is only shown with a calculation and the customer's agreement.

Examples of good ones

Your own misdiagnosis notes give us the best stories. Here are examples of the kinds of job to look out for, and what each one proves.

The job	The story	What it proves	Who it speaks to
A damp proof course that had not failed	Damp that looked like rising damp was caused by debris, slumped insulation or a raised ground level bridging a working damp proof course	You find the cause before you treat	Homeowners and buyers
Condensation mistaken for damp	A wall treated or blamed for damp, but humidity, heating and ventilation were the cause	Honest advice, sometimes with no works	Homeowners with mould, landlords
An old chimney-breast salt problem	Re-plastering had failed more than once because salts kept drawing in moisture	You understand why repairs fail	Homeowners with a returning problem
A woodworm scare	Old flight holes, no active infestation, no treatment needed	You do not sell treatment you do not need	Homeowners and buyers
Wet rot or dry rot	The two look similar but need very different repairs	Accurate identification changes the outcome	Timber and heritage owners
Cement on an old wall	Cement render or paint trapping moisture in a traditional building, put right with breathable materials	Heritage knowledge	Period and listed owners
A basement as a designed system	A cellar or basement that needed proper design, not a coating	Specialist waterproofing skill	Basement owners in Brighton, Hove and London
A survey that ended with advice only	The report found no problem needing works, and the customer avoided an expensive job	The survey is worth paying for on its own	Everyone, especially buyers
A survey that changed a purchase	A buyer used the findings to renegotiate or decide, with their permission	The survey gives real decisions, not just paper	Buyers, solicitors, agents
A landlord's recurring mould	A documented investigation separating building defects from how the home is used	A professional, recorded process	Landlords and letting agents
Earlier repair work that did not solve the problem	A careful reassessment of what had been done and why it did not work, without naming anyone	You can sort out problems others could not	Homeowners who were let down
A council or housing job	A damp and mould investigation for a council or housing provider, with their permission	You can be relied on by councils, and your reports hold up	Councils and housing providers
A Surrey or London job	A period property or basement outside Sussex	The group works beyond its home area	Buyers and owners in those areas

When we choose between jobs, we pick the one where the evidence is strongest and the customer is happy to be used.

11. Your videos

The site has four case study films. The next step is you talking to camera, which is what the "From the Founder" section on the About page is waiting for. You are the face of the videos, and Adam checks the technical points before anything goes out.

The first session, about half a day

Video	What you cover	Where it goes
1. Why the businesses came together	How Sussex Damp Experts became Damp Experts Group, how Insitu and 1st Call Heritage joined it, what each brings, what stays the same, what improves	Homepage, About, LinkedIn
2. Diagnosed properly. Repaired properly.	Why the same damp patch can have several causes, why you start with the cause, and what you will tell someone who does not need work	Every landing page, Facebook, Instagram
3. What happens during a survey	Outside first, then inside, the readings, what the written report contains, when it arrives and what it costs	Survey pages, booking page, landing pages
4. Why paying for a proper diagnosis matters	Survey first, quote separately, the report is theirs either way, and where the £100 credit fits	Buyer page, survey pages, LinkedIn

In the same session we shoot three to six short cuts for social, and some stills.

The shoot day

Film videos 2 and 3 on a real job or a property with a real problem, so you can point at what you are talking about. Take a moisture meter, a thermal camera and a few real survey photos, and explain that these are evidence tools that support the diagnosis, not proof on their own. Film videos 1 and 4 somewhere calm and well lit. Keep each answer under three minutes and stop when the point is made, because we can cut shorter versions from it afterwards. We recommend also putting your longer videos on YouTube, because people search there for how-to answers, and linking them from the site.

Then about one session a month

One video for each of the five service areas, then you answer real questions. Here are twenty, taken from what people search for and from your own documents.

1. How much does a damp survey cost, and what do you get?
2. Is damp a dealbreaker when buying a house?
3. Rising damp or condensation: how to tell the difference.
4. Why does my damp meter read high when there is no damp?
5. Do I need a damp survey before I buy, and can I use the seller's?
6. When is injection the right answer, and when is it not?
7. Penetrating damp: gutters, pointing and render.
8. Black mould in the bedroom: what causes it and what fixes it.
9. Does an extractor or a dehumidifier fix condensation?
10. Woodworm: is it active, and do I need to treat it?

11. Dry rot or wet rot, and what it costs to put right.
12. Damp cellars and basements: tanking or a drainage system?
13. Damp in a listed or period house, and why modern damp courses and cement render can make it worse.
14. Lime plaster or gypsum: what belongs on the wall?
15. Damp after a new damp course: why it still feels damp.
16. Damp in a flat: who is responsible, you or the freeholder?
17. What Awaab's Law means for landlords, and what it does not yet cover.
18. A landlord's guide to a tenant's mould complaint.
19. What a timber survey looks at in an old roof and floor.
20. Should you walk away from a house with damp?

How the filming works

You speak from a short list of points, not a script, so it sounds like you. Each short video opens with the hook in the first two or three seconds, has subtitles, plain English, one message and one next step. We tag every video by service, area and audience so we can match it to the right page or campaign, and we will see which ones people actually watch.

Good openers for you: "This wall is not rising damp." "What a surveyor sees in the first 30 seconds." "What I check first in a house you're thinking of buying."

Professional filming is quoted separately from the monthly fees.

12. Social media

Social media builds familiarity with people who have already seen an ad or visited the site. It can also bring in direct enquiries, referrals and discovery, so we count useful messages, enquiries, site visits and bookings alongside video views.

Platform	What it is for	How often	Mostly
Facebook	Local reach, homeowner advice, landlords	3 to 4 a week	Short films, case studies, seasonal advice
Instagram	Showing the team is capable	3 to 4 a week, mainly reels	Reels, before and afters, myth and fact
LinkedIn	Credibility with landlords, agents, housing teams, surveyors and architects	2 a week	Your views, technical case studies, complex investigations
Google Business Profile	Local search and trust	Weekly	Job photos, short videos, posts with a booking link

A steady rhythm beats bursts, and it is what a small team can keep up. Over a month the mix is roughly 30 per cent education, 25 per cent projects and case studies, 20 per cent surveys and investigations, 15 per cent customer proof, and 10 per cent team and brand.

Series that give us something every week. Damp or not damp: a photo, a guess, then your answer. Ask Alex: one real question a week. What the survey found: an anonymised case in 30 seconds. Before you buy: what you look at first. Myth and

fact: short cards on the misdiagnoses. Old house, right materials: lime, breathability and cement. Seasonal: condensation, mould, water ingress and timber decay in autumn and winter.

The first twelve weeks.

Weeks	Focus	Example posts
1 to 2	Introducing the group and the four case studies	Your welcome video, the Horsham bridged damp proof course as a reel, the Tunbridge Wells dry rot film as a short story
3 to 4	How a survey works	A survey walkthrough, what is in the report, price and credit explained
5 to 6	Autumn damp	Condensation and mould series, damp or not damp, does an extractor fix condensation
7 to 8	Buyers	What to check before you buy, when to walk away, why a buyer's survey flags damp
9 to 10	Heritage	Lime or cement, timber framing, the Grade II beetle case, why old walls need to breathe
11 to 12	Landlords and agents	Handling a mould complaint, what a documented investigation looks like, what Awaab's Law does and does not cover

On Facebook, local community groups often ban promotion, so you would answer questions helpfully there without links. On LinkedIn, your own profile carries the voice, with posts like "what to tell tenants about condensation" and "what a survey report should contain", and the company page holds the formal content.

13. Facebook and Instagram advertising, later

This does not start yet. Google Ads catches people already searching, so we recommend it goes first, and the ads on Facebook and Instagram build on what it shows us. That is our sequencing advice, not a rule. We start Facebook and Instagram when booking works end to end, consent is in place, customer handling is reliable, we have enough of your films and case studies to run for two months without repeating ourselves, and we can fund a useful test. We begin with one area and one clear offer rather than spreading a small budget across every county.

While we wait, we set up what the advertising will need and grow organic video views and site visitors, which become the first people we show ads to again.

When it starts, there are two campaigns. One introduces the group to new people in the first area, using your films and case studies, and we add the next areas once the results justify it. The other shows people who have already watched your videos or visited the site more proof and the next step. We propose to start by sending clicks to the landing page and booking page, with Facebook's own lead forms available to test later if the numbers support it. The ads will say things like "Damp in your home?" and will not imply anything about anyone's health.

Ideas for the ads themselves. You on site pointing at the actual problem ("this is not rising damp, it is condensation"). A 30 to 45 second case study: the symptom, the diagnosis, the result. A swipe-through of "three signs it is not rising damp". We

upload your video files straight to Meta rather than linking to them, which works better. People who watched a good part of a video or visited the site recently can be included in the retargeting audiences, as long as the platform has enough of them and they have agreed to tracking, and people who have already booked can be left out.

Plan 2 suggested £6,000 over six months, reducing each month. That is a planning reference, not an approved budget. For each test we agree the spend, how long it runs, what success looks like and when we stop to review, and we only expand if the results and the margin support it.

14. Referrals from estate agents, surveyors and solicitors

Estate agents, surveyors, solicitors and letting agents can send you work too. We would build a one-page pack for them: what you cover and where, your credentials, a clear turnaround and a named contact, plus a simple "refer a client" form. You approve a short list of people to approach, and we prepare the materials and the outreach wording. We track the introductions and the surveys that result, not just the number of contacts. Some professions have rules on referral payments, so we would check before offering anything.

15. Areas

Our content follows the areas Ben is targeting, and the location pages in section 8 follow the same order. Sussex is the first emphasis because it is where the group has its history. Kent, Surrey and London follow as Ben's campaigns, travel costs and your surveyors' capacity allow. Spending does not go up just because a new county is added. It moves towards the places and services that bring in booked surveys.

Area	Why	What we lean on
Sussex	Home ground, strongest reputation	Everyday damp, timber, condensation, basements
Kent	Lots of period, timber-framed and heritage property	Listed buildings, timber, heritage repair
Surrey	Higher-value homes	Basements, structural waterproofing, period surveys
London	Premium and selective	Basement waterproofing, listed and Victorian properties, pre-purchase

Until there are more, the four case studies are used for every area, and new jobs, in Surrey and London especially, become the next ones. London is a set of chosen areas rather than one big market, and low-value generic searches do not get the same priority.

16. More ideas to test later

These come from the survey packages brief and our research. None is for the first 90 days, but they are worth having on the list.

- **Property Health Check.** An annual building health report with a score, a bit like an MOT, from the survey packages brief. It suits landlords, letting agents and people with older homes.
- **Bronze, silver and gold survey tiers,** which the brief flagged as a possible idea.
- **WhatsApp photo triage.** A photo sent by WhatsApp can help someone choose the right survey, but it cannot give a reliable diagnosis, so we would say so clearly.
- **A pre-winter damp check campaign** aimed at older homes in early autumn.
- **Estate agent and solicitor partnerships** beyond the first pack, such as workshops for property professionals and conservation groups, which also produce useful video.
- **A portfolio offer for letting agents** with several properties, with one report format and a named contact.
- **Council and housing outreach.** Check which council supplier lists and procurement portals the group should be on, and introduce the team to housing officers by LinkedIn and in person.
- **Local community involvement,** such as talks for residents' groups and conservation societies, filmed for social.

17. The first 90 days

When	Focus	What happens
Week 1	Check everything works	Agree with Ben what will be counted, and start the weekly check-ins with him. Confirm website statistics are being recorded. Make sure enquiries reach your office and the CRM.
Weeks 2 to 3	Get ready for paid traffic	Test the whole journey from ad to payment: forms, calls, WhatsApp, booking and payment, the CRM record, accepted and rejected cookie choices, and that a purchase is never counted twice. Use test payments where possible, or one small authorised live booking. Book your video session.
Weeks 3 to 4	Content starts	Your first four videos are filmed. The case studies go out as social series. The first one-page pack goes to estate agents, surveyors and solicitors. Buyer page and "meet your surveyor" in build.
Month 2	First look at the data	First monthly report. First Kent location pages. Second video session for the service films. First new case study. Council and housing page built, using what you can share about your council work.
Month 3	Set targets	Agree target costs with you using real job values. Decide whether Facebook and Instagram advertising starts. Improve the weakest landing pages. First Surrey location pages. Heritage and landlord pages.
Months 4 to 6	Focus	Advertising on Facebook and Instagram starts if the conditions are met. Money and content move to the strongest areas and services. Refresh creative.

18. Fees

These figures come from Plan 2 and exclude VAT. Together the organic fees come to £1,000 a month, or £1,250 with Facebook and Instagram advertising management. That is not the full cost of this plan, so we agree what each line

includes before it becomes a committed retainer. Google Ads management and spend belong to Ben and are not included.

Service	Monthly fee	Starts
Facebook and Instagram content management	£750	On approval
LinkedIn content management	£250	On approval
Facebook and Instagram advertising management	£250	When advertising starts
Monitoring, reporting and liaison with Ben	To be priced	On approval
Search (SEO) and Google Business Profile work	To be priced	On approval
Location page batches (about 10 pages each)	To be quoted per batch	As agreed
Case study writing and page build	To be priced	On approval
Website additions in section 9	To be quoted per item	As agreed

Professional filming and photography, editing beyond the footage supplied, large design jobs, printing and third-party software are quoted separately. Facebook and Instagram ad spend is on hold. LinkedIn advertising is optional and only worth considering once organic LinkedIn is getting a response.

19. What we will keep out of our marketing

The damp trade attracts complaints about overselling, so we want to be careful.

- No guarantee period in ads or social posts.
- No claim that Awaab's Law applies to private landlords.
- No claim of independence beyond what we can show: the survey is paid, the report is yours, and there is no obligation to use us for the work.
- No promise that every lender or solicitor will accept a report.
- No rating or review count in ads until the Google profile shows it.
- No health wording in Facebook and Instagram ads, because Meta restricts it.
- No remote diagnosis from a photograph.
- No criticism of named competitors or other contractors without evidence.
- No "free survey" wording, because the survey is paid.
- No customer photos, names or addresses without written permission.
- No claim that a moisture meter finds rising damp, and no "100% cure".
- No statistic from a source we cannot check.